🏫 FOR TEACHER USE

SWIM & WATER SAFETY TEACHER RESOURCE GUIDE

A complete unit resource for Health & Physical Education teachers in Victorian secondary schools. Includes lesson plans, answer keys, teaching notes, assessment rubrics, and curriculum alignment.

TEACHER RESOURCE GUIDE

📅 Year 7–8

📚 HPE · Safety Focus Area

🗓 4–6 Lessons (~50 min each)

🎓 Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0

📍 Victorian Secondary School Context

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📌 1. Curriculum Alignment

Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 — Health & Physical Education

Victorian government and Catholic schools must implement Curriculum 2.0 from 2026. Swimming and water safety is a **mandated priority area** alongside respectful relationships, embedded across both HPE strands.

Content Description	Code	Strand	How This Unit Addresses It
Plan and implement strategies, using health resources, to enhance their own and others' health, safety, relationships and wellbeing	`VC2HP8P10`	Personal, Social & Community Health	Students investigate water safety strategies and evaluate their effectiveness for Victorian contexts

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Content Description	Code	Strand	How This Unit Addresses It
Plan and implement strategies, using health resources, to enhance their own and others' health, safety, relationships and wellbeing	VC2HP8P10	Personal, Social & Community Health	Students develop personal action plans and community awareness activities around drowning prevention
Investigate how media and influential people in the community impact attitudes, beliefs, decisions and behaviours in relation to health, safety, relationships and wellbeing	VC2HP8P09	Personal, Social & Community Health	Students analyse LSV drowning data and evaluate the credibility of health/safety information sources
Refine and perform specialised movement skills in aquatic environments	VC2HP8M01	Movement & Physical Activity	Students apply survival swimming and rescue techniques in pool sessions (partner unit)
Refine protective behaviours and evaluate community resources to seek help for themselves and others (including basic first aid and CPR)	VC2HP8P08	Personal, Social & Community Health	Students identify social barriers (peer pressure) to safe decisions near water

🎯 Focus Areas (Victorian Curriculum 2.0)

- **Safety (S)** — Core: safe practices near and in water, emergency response, recognising hazards
- **Lifelong Physical Activities (LPA)** — Swimming as a lifelong health-enhancing skill
- **Fundamental Movement Skills (FMS)** — Aquatic movement and survival skills

📊 Achievement Standard Connections — Levels 7 & 8

By the end of Level 8, students are expected to:

- Investigate strategies that enhance their own and others' health, safety and wellbeing

- Justify actions that promote their own and others' health, safety and wellbeing in community contexts
- Gather and analyse health information to make informed decisions
- Explain personal and social skills required to establish respectful relationships and promote inclusivity
- Demonstrate control and accuracy when performing specialised movement skills

Source: https://f10.vcaa.vic.edu.au/health-and-physical-education/curriculum/f-10

🗺 2. Unit Overview & Learning Intentions

🔍 What this unit does not do, and why

Most teaching resources list what they cover. This lists what they do not, because a limit you know about is something you can plan around and a limit you discover in week three is a problem. Three of these are deliberate scope decisions; one is genuinely undone; one is not something any document can supply.

What is missing	What that means for you	Why it is like that
Most of the HPE curriculum	This unit addresses 10 of the 40 Victorian content descriptions. It services *Safety* substantially and contributes to three other focus areas. It does not touch the other eight.	**Deliberate.** It is a water safety unit, not a program. The Curriculum Coverage Map lists every code it does not address so your planning can place them elsewhere.
Evidence of student achievement	The curriculum codes record what was *taught*. They are not, by themselves, evidence that students achieved anything.	**Deliberate.** Victorian Curriculum 2.0 reports against achievement standards. Evidence comes from the rubrics, work samples and your moderation — not from a coverage map.

What is missing	What that means for you	Why it is like that
Tiered intervention	The scaffolded and simplified versions are Tier 1 differentiation. They are not a Tier 2 or 3 intervention program and should not be counted as one.	**Deliberate.** Intervention is designed around a student, by your school, on data this unit does not hold.
Flexible grouping on evidence	The lessons use whole-class and fixed-pair structures. They do not tell you to form and re-form groups during a lesson based on what you are seeing.	**Genuinely open, and the one gap left.** VTLM 2.0 asks for groups formed on evidence of learning. That decision depends on what is in front of you, so the materials prompt it (see the checks-for-understanding repertoire) but cannot script it. Worth adding to your own lesson notes.
Everything that happens in the room	Classroom rules and routines, active supervision, how you respond to a student in the moment, the relationships you build with students and families.	**Not a document's job.** A resource can prompt these; it cannot evidence them. An alignment document that claimed otherwise would be worth less than this one.

Why this section exists at all. This unit was audited in October 2026 against all 14 teaching strategies of the Victorian Teaching and Learning Model 2.0. Twenty technique-level gaps were found; nineteen were closed, and the one that was not is in the table above. The full audit, including what was changed and what the model asks that a resource suite structurally cannot deliver, is in the VTLM 2.0 Alignment Guide. If you are documenting VTLM implementation for an Annual Implementation Plan, read that rather than this summary.

📐 Unit Overview

Element	Detail
Unit Title	Swim & Water Safety: Making Smart Choices in Victorian Waters
Year Level	Year 7–8 (Ages 12–14)

Element	Detail
Duration	4–6 × 50-minute lessons (can be expanded for swimming carnival unit)
Setting	Fully classroom-based / dry-land (no pool required) + optional pool/excursion component
Key Resources	Student workbook (Sections 1–6), Poster pack (4 posters), Scenario activity cards (14 cards), Assessment gradebook, Resource directory, internet access for research tasks
Partner Organisations	Life Saving Victoria (LSV), RLSSA Swim & Survive, Paddle Australia, Parks Victoria, VCAA, DE, St John Ambulance Victoria
Prerequisite Knowledge	Basic swimming at primary level; Victorian Water Safety Certificate (Foundation–Year 6)
Dry-land Suitability	✅ All activities in this unit can be delivered without water access — explicitly supported by Victorian Curriculum 2.0 and LSV Toolkit

✅ Learning Intentions — What students will know, understand and be able to do:

KNOW (Knowledge)	UNDERSTAND (Conceptual)	DO (Skills)
• Current Victorian drowning statistics • Beach flag system and meanings • DRS ABCD action plan • LSV SwimSafe 5 rules • What a rip current is • Cold water shock effects • Key risk factors for young people • Throw rescue hierarchy	• Why unpatrolled locations are more dangerous • Why young males are overrepresented in drowning data • How peer pressure influences risky decisions near water • Why alcohol and water is a deadly combination • The relationship between knowledge, skills and safety outcomes	• Apply DRS ABCD in a simulated emergency • Analyse and interpret drowning data • Make and justify safe decisions in water scenarios • Rank and demonstrate throw rescue equipment choices • Map hazards across different Victorian water environments • Create a water safety communication product for a real audience • Locate patrolled beaches using the BeachSafe app

💬 Essential Questions

- *Why does Victoria have such a high drowning rate compared to its population size?*
- *What decisions, information and skills could prevent most Victorian drowning deaths?*
- *How do social factors (peer pressure, gender norms, overconfidence) increase risk near water?*
- *What is my personal responsibility to be water safe and to help keep others safe?*

- *Why are rivers and inland waterways just as dangerous — or more so — than the beach?*

🏛 Partner Organisations — Reference Table

This unit draws on best-practice frameworks from the following organisations. All are free to access for Victorian teachers.

Organisation	Primary Use in This Unit	Key URL
Life Saving Victoria (LSV)	SwimSafe rules, annual drowning data, classroom lessons, multicultural resources, LSV Toolkit	`https://lsv.com.au` `https://lsv.com.au/toolkit`
RLSSA — Swim and Survive	Dry-land classroom modules, Bronze e-Lifesaving (risk-taking, peer pressure, alcohol), throw rescue guidelines	`https://www.royallifesaving.com.au` `https://www.drowningprevention.org.au/swimandsurvive`
VCAA	Curriculum 2.0 content descriptions, achievement standards, sample swimming activities F–10	`https://f10.vcaa.vic.edu.au` `https://www.vcaa.vic.edu.au/curriculum/foundation-10/curriculum-area-resources/health-and-physical-education/teaching-resources`
Victorian Dept of Education	Swimming policy, funding, toolkit, excursion guidelines	`https://www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/swimming-instruction-and-water-safety-education/policy`
Paddle Australia	Inland waterway safety — rivers, lakes, moving water; relevant to Yarra, Goulburn, Alpine regions	`https://paddle.org.au`
Parks Victoria	Natural waterway hazard awareness; localised Victorian scenarios for classroom use	`https://www.parks.vic.gov.au`
AUSTSWIM	Teacher training frameworks; lesson progression models; inclusion strategies	`https://austswim.com.au`

Organisation	Primary Use in This Unit	Key URL
St John Ambulance Vic	DRS ABCD, CPR, first aid resources; free printable guides for classroom use	`https://www.stjohnvic.com.au/first-aid-resources/`
BeachSafe (SLSA)	Student research task: find nearest patrolled beaches; check conditions and patrol times	`https://beachsafe.org.au`
American Red Cross	"Think So You Don't Sink" decision-making model; engaging videos for secondary students	`https://www.redcross.org/take-a-class/water-safety`
CDC Drowning Prevention (USA)	International data for numeracy/cross-curricular comparison tasks; risk factor research	`https://www.cdc.gov/drowning/prevention`

💧 Best-Practice Dry-Land Teaching Approaches

This unit is **fully deliverable without water access**. The following approaches are drawn from LSV, RLSSA, and AUSTSWIM best practice for no-pool environments:

Approach	How It's Used in This Unit	Key Resource
Scenario-Based Learning	12 printable scenario cards covering beach, river, pool, emergency, and decision-making contexts. All Victorian settings.	Scenario Activity Cards (separate file)
Role Play & Simulation	Throw rescue with towels/ropes (L3); 000 call role-play; DRS ABCD sequencing on mats	Lesson 3 plan; Workbook Section 3
Hazard Mapping	Students analyse beach, river, and pool environments to identify and rank hazards by risk level	Workbook Activity 4.0

Approach	How It's Used in This Unit	Key Resource
Data Analysis (Numeracy)	LSV 2024–25 drowning data; calculate percentages by age group, location, gender	Workbook Sections 1, 5; Extension Card X1
Decision-Making Models	SwimSafe rules (LSV), throw rescue hierarchy (RLSSA), "Think So You Don't Sink" (Red Cross)	Workbook Sections 4, 5; Poster 4
Communication Tasks (Literacy)	Three-option campaign task: social media post, letter to younger student, or multilingual fact sheet	Workbook Activity 6.2; Scenario Card X2

📌 RECOMMENDED "BEST COMBO" FOR VICTORIAN SCHOOLS

Core: Life Saving Victoria (LSV Toolkit) as your primary source — local, curriculum-aligned, free. **Structure:** RLSSA Swim and Survive classroom modules for lesson sequencing. **Compliance:** Victorian DE + VCAA for documentation. **Enhance with:** Paddle Australia for inland waterway content, Red Cross videos for student engagement, Parks Vic for localised Victorian scenarios.



3. VTLM 2.0 Teaching Techniques for This Unit

The Victorian Teaching and Learning Model 2.0 names specific techniques within each of its 14 teaching strategies. This section supplies them for this unit — the actual scripts, tables and schedules, not a restatement of the model. Each block is tagged with the strategy it serves so you can cite it in an Annual Implementation Plan or a VTLM reflection session.

3.1 Advance organiser — the unit in one picture FOCUS THE LEARNING · P2

Display this at the start of Lesson 1, then return to it at the start of every lesson and point to where the class now is. An advance organiser is not a summary: it is shown *before* the content, so students can hang new knowledge on a structure they already hold.

Lesson	The question it answers	What it connects to
1. The problem	Who drowns in Victoria, and why them?	Students' own local waterways, named in the opening hook. Nothing precedes this lesson.
2. Reading the water	How do I tell safe water from dangerous water?	Builds on L1's "where" — the coastal share of deaths becomes a reason to read a beach.

Lesson	The question it answers	What it connects to
3. When it goes wrong	What do I actually do?	Needs L2: you cannot decide on a rescue without knowing what a rip is doing to the person.
4. Inland and alcohol	Why are rivers and lakes different?	Applies L2's hazard-reading to water with no flags, no patrol and no visibility.
5. Telling other people	How do I get this to someone who needs it?	Requires all four: the campaign has to carry accurate content from each lesson.

Say the dependency aloud each lesson — "you cannot do today without last lesson, and here is why." That sentence is the organiser doing its work.

3.2 Checks for understanding — the repertoire `MONITOR PROGRESS · P1`

Every lesson in this unit ends with an exit ticket. That is one technique at one moment. VTLM 2.0 asks for frequent checks *during* explanation and practice, with every student responding rather than volunteers. Use these inside the **I do** and **we do** phases.

Technique	Use it here	What it tells you
Hand signals	"Thumb up if it is safe to swim here, down if it is not, sideways if you need more information" — over four beach photographs in L2.	Whole-class read in five seconds. Sideways thumbs are the useful ones; ask one of them what information they want.
Mini-whiteboards	"Write the next letter of DRS ABCD" — six quick rounds in L3, all boards up at once.	Shows you who is sequencing and who is guessing from the person beside them.
Cold call	After the rip explanation in L2: "Mia, what are you swimming towards, and why not the beach?" Name first, question second, no hands.	Keeps every student ready to answer, not just the three who always volunteer.
Hinge question	Mid-L3, before practice: "You find someone face-down in a pool. You are alone. First action: (a) start compressions (b) call 000 (c) check for danger (d) pull them out."	A deliberate fork. If more than a few pick (a) or (d), re-teach Danger before any practice begins.
Turn-and-talk	Already used in L1 and L4. Follow it with a cold call on what their *partner* said.	Makes the pair talk accountable instead of social.

Technique	Use it here	What it tells you
Exit ticket	In place at the end of all five lessons.	Retrospective. Good for planning the next lesson, too late to change this one.

The point of the first five is that they happen while you can still change what you do. Choose two per lesson and plan where they land, rather than improvising.

Peer review needs a frame. This unit asks students to peer review in several places — the campaign, the debate, the portfolio. Unframed peer review produces "good job, maybe add more colour." Give students three slots and require all three:

Slot	Sentence stem	Applied to the Lesson 5 campaign
Kind	"The strongest part is… because…"	Forces a reason, so it cannot be "it looks good."
Specific	"In the [name the part], I noticed…"	Must point at one element — the headline, the statistic, the image choice.
Helpful	"One change that would meet criterion [X] is…"	Ties the suggestion to a success criterion, not to personal taste.

Then leave class time for the author to act on it. Feedback students have no time to use is feedback that teaches them feedback does not matter.

3.3 Think-aloud scripts `EXPLICIT EXPLANATION AND MODELLING · P2`

Demonstrating a skill shows students the actions. Thinking aloud shows them the decisions — which is the part they have to reproduce when no teacher is present. Use these close to verbatim the first time.

LESSON 2 · READING A BEACH PHOTOGRAPH

"Right — before I decide anything, I am looking for the flags. I can see red and yellow on the left, so that is where the patrol wants me. Now I am looking at the water *between* them … it is choppy, breaking white. Good. Now I look right, past the flags, and that is where I slow down: that patch is darker and it looks calmer. My instinct says calm means safe, and that instinct is exactly wrong here — calm, dark and no breaking waves is water moving *out*. I can also see a bit of foam trailing seaward. So: I swim on the left, between the flags, and I would not put a toe in that darker channel. Notice what I did — I did not look for danger first, I looked for the flags first, then checked my own instinct against what the water was doing."

LESSON 3 · DECIDING ON A RESCUE

> “Someone is in trouble ten metres off the bank. I can swim — I am a good swimmer, and that is the thought I have to argue with, because the statistics are full of good swimmers. So I run the order. Danger first: is it safe for *me*? No — that is moving water and I would be in it with a panicking person. So I am not going in. What can I reach them with? I am looking around — there is a branch, there is my jumper, there is an esky lid. The esky lid floats and I can throw it. So: I call out to them to float, I throw the lid, I phone 000, and I stay on the bank talking to them. I have done more for them from here than I would have done as a second person in the water.”

Both scripts deliberately name a wrong instinct and then argue with it. That is the move worth copying: students hold the misconception, so model overriding it rather than pretending it is absent.

3.4 Examples and non-examples `EXPLICIT EXPLANATION AND MODELLING · P2`

Water safety is full of concepts students half-hold. A non-example marks the boundary of a concept and pre-empts the misconception. Present them in pairs and ask what changed.

Concept	Example	Non-example	The misconception it heads off
Patrolled location	A surf beach between the red-and-yellow flags, 1pm on a January Sunday.	The same beach, same flags still in the sand, 7pm after the patrol has gone.	That “patrolled” describes the place rather than the hours.
Rip current	A darker, calmer channel with foam trailing seaward and no breaking waves.	A wide area of white, broken, choppy water.	That calm water is safe water.
A rescue you can attempt	Throwing a boogie board from the bank and talking the person into floating.	Swimming out to tow a panicking person back, because you made the swim team.	That being a strong swimmer makes a swim rescue safe.
What drowning looks like	Silent, upright, mouth at water level, no arm waving, under in 20–60 seconds.	Shouting for help and waving both arms above the head.	The film version — which is why bystanders miss it happening metres away.

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Concept	Example	Non-example	The misconception it heads off
Supervising a child	An adult within arm's reach, eyes on the child, phone down.	An adult in the same backyard, reading, while the child is in the pool.	That being nearby is the same as supervising. This one matters: a quarter of Victoria's 2024–25 drowning deaths were in home environments.
Cold water shock	Jumping into a 13°C Victorian river in October — involuntary gasp, then hyperventilation, within the first minute.	A cold shower, which is unpleasant but does not take breathing control away.	That cold water is a comfort problem rather than a breathing problem.
Wearing a life jacket	Correct size, buckled, crotch strap done up, worn before leaving the ramp.	Two jackets stowed under the seat of the boat, as the law requires them to be carried.	That carrying one is being protected by one.

After each pair, ask the question that does the teaching: *"What exactly changed between these two?"* Students who can answer that hold the concept; students who cannot are recognising pictures.

3.5 Scaffolds, and when to take them away `SCAFFOLD PRACTICE · P1–P3`

This unit is well supplied with scaffolds — word banks, sentence starters, scaffolded and simplified workbooks, answer keys. What it has not previously stated is when to *withdraw* them. A scaffold left in place past proficiency stops being support and starts being a ceiling.

Scaffold	Fade it when the student…	Fade it to…
Sentence starters in the written responses	completes two responses using the starter without re-reading it.	a bare prompt word, then nothing.
Word bank for the glossary terms	uses three of the terms unprompted in discussion.	a bank with the terms removed but the definitions left, then self-recall.
Hazard table with categories pre-filled	adds a hazard you did not list.	an empty table with the column headings only.

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Scaffold	Fade it when the student…	Fade it to…
DRS ABCD prompt card during role-play	runs the sequence twice without glancing at the card.	card face down on the mat, available but not in view, then away.
Scaffolded workbook version	finishes a scaffolded section early and accurately.	the standard version for the next section, not the next unit.

Fade per student and per task, not per class. The scaffolded workbook is a response to a current need, not a label — a student can be on the scaffolded version for the data section and the standard version for the rescue section in the same lesson.

3.6 Review schedule `REVISIT AND REVIEW · P1–P2 · VARY PRACTICE · P2`

The retrieval starters in Lessons 2–5 are daily review. VTLM 2.0 also asks for weekly and monthly routines, because the drop in retention is steepest soon after learning. This unit has an advantage most units do not: there is a real external deadline. The knowledge has to be available in January, not in the week of the assessment.

Interval	When	What to retrieve, and how
Daily	Start of Lessons 2–5	Three or four questions from prior lessons, no notes, self-marked, ungraded. Already built in.
Weekly	End of the unit week	Brain dump: five minutes, blank page, everything you can recall about keeping yourself alive in water. Then compare against the glossary and add what was missed in a different colour. The gaps are the review list.
Monthly	One starter in each of the next two HPE units	Four interleaved questions mixing water safety with the current unit’s content, so students have to work out which knowledge applies before they answer. Interleaving is the point — do not label which question is which.
Pre-summer	Final HPE lesson before the summer holidays	Fifteen minutes. Scenario cards, cold-called, no notes: a river in January, a backyard pool with a toddler, an unpatrolled beach at dusk. Hand out How to Revise Water Safety at the start of this session — its 20 no-notes questions are built for it. This is the retrieval that matters — Victorian drowning deaths peak over summer, and this is the last time you will have these students before then.

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3.7 Group work protocols APPLY LEARNING AND BUILD MASTERY · P2

The Lesson 5 communication campaign and the Year 9–10 community action project are both group tasks. VTLM 2.0 asks that group work protocols be explicitly taught, not assumed, and that participation be accountable. Teach this once, in four minutes, before the campaign begins.

Role	Does	Is accountable for
Evidence keeper	Finds and records every statistic used, with its source and year.	Reporting to the group if a figure cannot be sourced — and the group dropping it.
Audience advocate	Asks, at each decision, whether the chosen audience would actually read this.	Naming the audience in one sentence at the start and holding the group to it.
Message editor	Cuts the wording down and checks it against the success criteria.	The final text being shorter than the first draft.
Designer	Decides format, layout and how the message is seen.	The format matching where the audience is, not personal preference.

Two rules, stated before groups form. **One:** the task is deliberately too large for one student, so a group that splits into one worker and three spectators will not finish — that is the design, not an accident. **Two:** each student writes one line at the end naming what they personally contributed, and the group signs off on it. That line is what makes the roles real.

3.8 Metacognitive prompts SELF-REGULATION · P2 · APPLY LEARNING · P2

VTLM 2.0 asks that students be taught to plan, monitor and evaluate their own learning, and that teachers model self-questioning aloud. Four prompts, used in this order, cover the cycle. They are worth putting on the wall for the duration of the unit.

Stage	Prompt	Where it lands in this unit
Comprehension	“What is this situation actually asking of me?”	Scenario cards. Most wrong answers are students solving a different scenario.
Connection	“Have I seen something like this before?”	Lesson 4’s inland hazards — the reading-the-water skill transfers from Lesson 2.

Stage	Prompt	Where it lands in this unit
Strategy	“What did I use last time, and does it apply here?”	Rescue decisions. The DRS order is the strategy; the question is whether they reach for it.
Reflection	“Was that the best choice? What would I change?”	After the role-play check and after the campaign self-assessment.

Model them on yourself first. In the Lesson 3 think-aloud above, “I am a good swimmer, and that is the thought I have to argue with” is a strategy prompt being used out loud. Students copy what they hear you do, not what they read on a wall.

3.9 A named process for analysis tasks — Read, Risk, Respond, Review

`APPLY LEARNING AND BUILD MASTERY · P2`

This unit asks students to analyse scenarios, case studies and hazard maps repeatedly, and until now it never told them *how*. “Analyse this scenario” is an instruction to produce an output, not a method for producing it, and students without a method default to narrating what happened. Four steps, taught once and then named every time:

Step	The question students ask themselves	What it stops them doing
Read	What is actually happening here, and what do I already know that fits?	Answering a scenario they have half-invented. Most wrong answers are a correct response to a different situation.
Risk	What is the hazard, who is exposed to it, and what makes it dangerous?	Jumping to a response before naming what the danger actually is.
Respond	What are my options, and which is safest for me *and* for them?	Offering the first idea. “Safest for me as well” is the clause that rules out the swim rescue.
Review	Would that have worked? What would I change?	Treating the first answer as the final one.

Say this out loud, or it will cause confusion. This unit now contains two four-part frameworks and students will conflate them. **DRS ABCD is what you do in the water, in an emergency, in that order. Read–Risk–Respond–Review is how you think about a situation on paper**, in class, when there is time. One is an action sequence; the other is an analysis method. Teach the distinction explicitly the first time you use the second one, and do not introduce them in the same lesson.

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Model it on one scenario card with a think-aloud, then name the steps each time students use it. The point is that they can say which step they are on — a process students cannot name is not a process they can transfer.

Where this sits. These are techniques, not a separate programme — each one is used inside the lesson plans that follow. The strategy-by-strategy audit of the whole suite, including what it still does not do, is in the VTLM 2.0 Alignment Guide.

📋 4. Lesson Plans

L1

Victoria's Drowning Crisis — Why It Matters to You

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Sections 1 | 🎯 VC2HP8P10, VC2HP8P09 | 🏫 Classroom

🎯 FOCUS THE LEARNING — 10 MIN

LEARNING OBJECTIVE

Understand who drowns in Victoria, where it happens and why, and explain why 15–24-year-olds are over-represented.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — SHARE THESE WITH STUDENTS

- ☐ I can state how many people drowned in Victoria in the most recent reporting year and name the two most common locations.
- ☐ I can describe at least three reasons why 15–24-year-olds are over-represented in the statistics.
- ☐ I can explain the difference between a number of deaths and a rate per 100,000 people, and say why the rate matters when comparing groups.

Opening Hook — "Could This Be You?"

- Begin with the question on the board: *"Name the THREE closest bodies of water to where you live."*
- Brief think-pair-share (2 min), then gather responses. Map on the whiteboard if possible.

- Show the statistic: **"In 2024–25, 52 people drowned in Victoria. There were no deaths in public swimming pools, the first time since 2019–20, but 25% happened in home environments. Seven were aged 15–24 — about 1 in 8, at a rate 21% above the ten-year average."**
- Ask: *"What does this make you feel? Were you surprised? Why or why not?"*

📣 EXPLICIT TEACHING – I DO — 15 MIN

Teacher-Led Discussion: Why Teenagers Are at Risk

- Walk through the key risk factors using Poster 3 as a visual reference (display on projector or print A3).
- Discuss: peer pressure, risk-taking during adolescence, gender and risk-taking behaviour, cultural background, overconfidence.
- Key teacher talking point: *"The reason this unit is important is not because any of you are irresponsible — it's because the research shows that the circumstances leading to drowning often come up quickly, in social settings, exactly like where you go in summer."*

🤝 GUIDED PRACTICE – WE DO — 15 MIN

Data Investigation

- Students complete Workbook Activity 1.1 (personal connection survey) independently — 5 min.
- Students examine the data table in Activity 1.2 and complete the 'What does this tell us?' column — 8 min.
- If internet available: students visit https://lsv.com.au/what-we-do/research-advocacy to cross-reference data.

✏️ INDEPENDENT APPLICATION – YOU DO — 8 MIN

Written Responses (Questions 1.2a and 1.2b)

- Students complete Questions 1.2a and 1.2b in their workbooks independently.
- Circulate to check understanding. Prompt students who are struggling with: *"Look at the data about WHERE drownings happen. What does that tell you?"*

📝 MONITOR PROGRESS — 5 MIN

Exit Ticket

- On a sticky note or scrap of paper: *"Write ONE fact from today that surprised you and ONE question you still have."*

- Collect at the door. Use questions to guide Lesson 2 content.

Review the success criteria. Return to the three success criteria on the board. Ask students to self-rate each one with a thumb (up / sideways / down). Any criterion with a spread of sideways and down thumbs is the one to re-teach at the start of Lesson 2.

📌 PEDAGOGICAL NOTES

- Avoid dramatising drowning deaths. The goal is empowerment through information, not fear. Keep a calm, factual tone.
- Be aware that some students may have had personal experience with drowning-related loss. Brief students at the start that if anything feels too personal, they can step out or talk to you privately.
- The gender discussion (males are 4× more likely to drown) is a strong discussion point — connect to broader HPE themes around gender norms, risk-taking, and social pressure. Handle sensitively.

⚠️ **Pastoral Care Note:** If any student discloses distress related to a drowning incident in their family or community, follow your school's wellbeing support protocols immediately. Before teaching this unit, read the cultural safety protocol — advance notice, opt-outs, First Nations protocols around deceased persons, and what to do if a student discloses. Have wellbeing referral information available before running this lesson.

L2

Beach Flags, Signals & Rip Current Survival

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Section 2 | 🎯 VC2HP8P10 | 🏫 Classroom

🔁 REVIEW — RETRIEVAL PRACTICE — 3 MIN

Retrieval starter — Lesson 1

- Three questions on the board, answered individually in books with no notes, then checked as a class (2 min). **1.** How many people drowned in Victoria in 2024–25? **2.** What share of those deaths happened in home environments? **3.** Name one reason 15–24-year-olds are over-represented.

Why this is here. Retrieving prior learning from memory, rather than re-reading it, is what moves it into long-term memory. Keep it low-stakes and ungraded — the point is the act of recall, not the score. VTLM 2.0: *Retention and recall*.

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🎯 FOCUS THE LEARNING — 8 MIN

LEARNING OBJECTIVE

Interpret beach safety signage, identify a rip current, and explain how to survive one.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — SHARE THESE WITH STUDENTS

- ☐ I can explain what the red and yellow flags mean and say exactly where it is safe to swim.
- ☐ I can identify a rip current in a photograph and name two visual signs I used.
- ☐ I can describe the three steps to take if caught in a rip, and explain why swimming straight for shore fails.

Flag Quiz — Prior Knowledge Probe

- Show images of 6 beach flags (from Poster 2 or online) on the projector — no labels.
- Students write on mini-whiteboards or paper: what does each one mean?
- Quick show of hands: *"Who has ever swum at a patrolled beach? Who always swims between the flags?"*
- Validate correct answers, address misconceptions immediately.

📣 EXPLICIT TEACHING – I DO — 12 MIN

Rip Currents — Teacher Explanation with Diagram

- Use the rip current diagram in the student workbook (projected on screen) to explain how rip currents form, how to identify them, and how to escape.
- Key analogy: *"A rip current is like a conveyor belt in the ocean taking you away from shore. You can't run against a conveyor belt — you step sideways off it."*
- Watch: Surf Life Saving Australia's rip current video: https://sls.com.au/surf-safety/rip-currents/ (approx 3–4 min)

🤝 GUIDED PRACTICE – WE DO — 12 MIN

Flag Identification Activity (Workbook 2.1)

- Students complete Activity 2.1 flag identification in workbooks independently.
- Then peer-check with a partner using Poster 2 as a reference.
- Whole-class share: which flag did most students get wrong? Discuss why.

✏️ INDEPENDENT APPLICATION – YOU DO — 12 MIN

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Scenario Analysis — Liam's Story (Activity 2.2) + Scenario Cards

- Students read the Liam scenario and answer questions 2.2a–c in their workbooks.
- Encourage students to use specific vocabulary: rip current, patrolled beach, parallel to shore, conserve energy.
- **Optional station rotation:** Use **Scenario Cards B1** (Unpatrolled Beach), **B2** (Caught in a Rip), and **B3** (The Flag Problem) from the Scenario Activity Card pack. Groups rotate every 8 minutes. Cards include teacher answer reveals — display on screen only, not student copies.

📝 MONITOR PROGRESS — 6 MIN

BeachSafe App Demo + SwimSafe Rules Introduction

- Demonstrate BeachSafe at https://beachsafe.org.au — show students how to find their nearest patrolled beach.
- Task: *"Find the three nearest patrolled beaches to your home using BeachSafe."* (homework or now if devices available)
- Preview next lesson: display **Poster 4 (SwimSafe Rules)** on projector. Quick verbal run-through of the 5 rules — students will do the full activity next lesson.

Review the success criteria. Re-read the success criteria aloud. Cold call three students, one per criterion, to answer it in a sentence. If the rip criterion is shaky, it carries directly into the Lesson 3 rescue content — re-teach rather than move on.

📌 EXTENSION ACTIVITY

Have students use Google Maps and BeachSafe to identify the nearest *unpatrolled* swimming spot to their home and list three hazards it might have. This brings the data to life for their own geography. Extension Card X1 (Data Analysis) can also be assigned at this point.

L3

Emergency Response — DRS ABCD & Rescue Skills

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Section 3 | 🎯 VC2HP8P10 | 🏫 Classroom + Practical

🔁 REVIEW — RETRIEVAL PRACTICE — 3 MIN

Retrieval starter — Lessons 1–2

- No notes, 2 min, then self-mark. **1.** What do the red and yellow flags mean? **2.** What are the three steps if caught in a rip? **3.** From Lesson 1: what was Victoria's drowning rate per 100,000?

Why this is here. Retrieving prior learning from memory, rather than re-reading it, is what moves it into long-term memory. Keep it low-stakes and ungraded — the point is the act of recall, not the score. VTLM 2.0: *Retention and recall*.

🎯 FOCUS THE LEARNING — 5 MIN

LEARNING OBJECTIVE

Apply the DRS ABCD action plan, and explain how to attempt a rescue without entering the water.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — SHARE THESE WITH STUDENTS

- ☐ I can recite DRS ABCD in order and say what each letter stands for.
- ☐ I can demonstrate correct hand position, depth and rate for CPR compressions.
- ☐ I can explain why a throw rescue is safer than a swim rescue, and name two objects I could use.

DRS ABCD — Reveal Game

- 7 chairs at the front, numbered 1–7. Each chair has a letter card face down (D, R, S, A, B, C, D).
- Ask 7 volunteers to come up and flip their cards. Class guesses the word for each letter.
- Award house points for correct answers to build engagement.

📣 EXPLICIT TEACHING & GUIDED PRACTICE — I DO → WE DO — 15 MIN

CPR Demonstration + Practice

- Use a CPR manikin (or demonstrate hand placement on a cushion/rolled-up mat).
- Demonstrate: head tilt-chin lift, check breathing (10 seconds), chest compressions (30 at 100–120 bpm, depth 5–6cm for adults), 2 rescue breaths.
- Students practise compressions in pairs on cushions/mats — emphasise: *"Harder than you think — don't be afraid to push."*
- **Hands-only CPR is acceptable and encouraged if students are uncomfortable with rescue breaths.**

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📣 EXPLICIT TEACHING — I DO

8 MIN

Throw Rescue Technique

- Demonstrate throw rescue: *throw the rope/towel so it lands PAST the person, so they can grab the floating end as it drifts back.*
- Practise with a coiled rope or a bundle of towels (classroom version: scrunched t-shirt).
- Key message: *"You do NOT need to enter the water. A throw rescue can save a life from the bank."*

✏️ INDEPENDENT APPLICATION — YOU DO

15 MIN

Workbook Activities 3.1 and 3.2 + Scenario Cards

- Students complete DRS ABCD table (Activity 3.1) and River Rope Swing scenario (Activity 3.2) in pairs.
- Discussion prompt: *"What is the FIRST thing you do before approaching someone who is injured?"* (Check for danger — too often people rush in and become casualties themselves.)
- **Scenario Cards E1** (Calling 000) and **E2** (Throw Rescue) from the Scenario Activity Card pack work well as pair/group follow-on tasks here. Card E2 directly reinforces the RLSSA throw rescue hierarchy from Activity 5.2 in the workbook.

📝 MONITOR PROGRESS

7 MIN

Role-Play Check

- One pair at a time (or selected pairs) role-play calling 000 using the DRS ABCD sequence.
- One person is the caller; teacher plays dispatcher. Other students observe and provide feedback.

Review the success criteria. Check the success criteria against what you observed in the role-play. CPR technique is the criterion students most often over-rate in self-assessment, so judge it on what you saw, not on what they report.

⚠️ **Practical Safety:** Ensure CPR practice surfaces are appropriate. Students with known cardiac conditions or injuries should be excused from physical compression practice but can observe and answer theory questions. Do not allow students to perform actual mouth-to-mouth on each other — use manikins or hands-only CPR for this lesson.

📌 NOTE ON CALLING 000

Remind students: when calling 000, say your location clearly (street address or nearest intersection), what happened, how many people are injured, and whether the person is breathing. Stay on the line — the operator will guide you through what to do next.

📌 RLSSA THROW RESCUE HIERARCHY

The Royal Life Saving Society Australia (RLSSA) recommend this rescue priority order: **(1) Talk** — shout instructions from safety; **(2) Reach** — extend something from the bank (pole, towel, clothing); **(3) Throw** — throw a buoyant object with a line; **(4) Row** — use a vessel if available; **(5) Go** — enter the water only if trained, never alone, always with a flotation device. Workbook Activity 5.2 asks students to apply this hierarchy. Source: https://www.royallifesaving.com.au

L4

Hazard Mapping, Safe Decisions, Inland Waterways & Alcohol

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Sections 4–5 | 🎯 VC2HP8P08, VC2HP8P10 | 🏫 Classroom

🔁 REVIEW – RETRIEVAL PRACTICE — 3 MIN

Retrieval starter — Lessons 1–3

- No notes, 2 min. **1.** Write out DRS ABCD in full. **2.** What is the compression rate for CPR? **3.** From Lesson 2: why should you never swim directly against a rip?

Why this is here. Retrieving prior learning from memory, rather than re-reading it, is what moves it into long-term memory. Keep it low-stakes and ungraded — the point is the act of recall, not the score. VTLM 2.0: *Retention and recall*.

🎯 FOCUS THE LEARNING — 8 MIN

LEARNING OBJECTIVE

Assess the hazards of Victorian inland waterways, and explain how cold water and alcohol increase drowning risk.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — SHARE THESE WITH STUDENTS

- ☐ I can identify at least four hazards on an inland waterway hazard map and say why each one is a hazard.

- [ ] I can explain what cold water shock does to the body in the first minute of immersion.
- [ ] I can describe two ways alcohol increases drowning risk, and apply the SwimSafe rules to a real decision.

"Would You?" — Values Clarification

- Read out scenarios. Students stand on one side of the room for "I would do it" and the other for "I wouldn't."
- Scenarios: *"Your 5 best friends dare you to jump off a cliff into a lake — it looks safe from above." / "It's 38°C and you're at a river, your friends are all swimming, and there's no lifeguard. You would…" / "You're at a party near a pool and a friend dares you to swim across even though you've been drinking."*
- After each: discuss WHY they chose their side. No judgment — this is a discussion, not an assessment.
- These directly mirror **Scenario Cards D1** (The Group Decision) and **D2** (Alcohol & Water) — which can be used as written follow-on tasks for this activity.

📣 EXPLICIT TEACHING – I DO — 10 MIN

Inland Waterways + Cold Water Shock — Victorian Context

- Explain cold water shock: involuntary gasp reflex, hyperventilation, sudden heart rate increase, muscle incapacitation.
- Victorian context: *"Alpine lakes like Lake Eildon are fed by snowmelt. Even in December they can sit at 12–15°C. Your body reacts within seconds of entering cold water — even in summer."*
- Reference **Paddle Australia** for river and moving-water safety: https://paddle.org.au — particularly relevant for students in Yarra Valley, Gippsland, or Alpine regions.
- Reference **Parks Victoria** (https://www.parks.vic.gov.au) for localised Victorian waterway hazard information students can research independently.
- **Scenario Cards R2** (After the Rain) and **R3** (Cold Water Shock) work well here as 5-minute quick writes or partner discussion tasks.

🤝 GUIDED PRACTICE – WE DO — 15 MIN

Hazard Mapping (Activity 4.0) + SwimSafe Rules (Workbook Section 4)

- Students complete **Activity 4.0 Hazard Mapping** — identifying and ranking hazards across beach, river/dam, and pool environments. Groups of 2–3 work well.
- Introduce the **LSV SwimSafe 5 Rules** using Poster 4. Ask students to copy the rules into their workbook Section 4 key knowledge box, then apply them to their hazard table responses.

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- Whole-class debrief: Which environment is most dangerous? Why do rivers and dams account for so many Victorian drowning deaths? (Refer to LSV data — https://lsv.com.au/what-we-do/research-advocacy)

✏️ INDEPENDENT APPLICATION — YOU DO **12 MIN**

Activities 4.1, 5.1, 5.2, 5.3, 5.4 + Risk vs Benefit

- Students complete the **Risk vs. Benefit Analysis table (4.1)** and Question 4.1a (peer pressure strategy) in pairs.
- Students complete **Activity 5.2 Throw Rescue ranking** — reinforces the RLSSA rescue hierarchy. Debrief: why is "jumping in" consistently ranked last?
- Students complete **Activity 5.3 Alcohol and Water** — this can be sensitive for some students. Normalise by framing it as a public health fact: *"Alcohol is mentioned in drowning reports every year — this is about understanding the risk, not making judgements."*
- Encourage authentic, specific action plans — not generic. Prompt: *"What will YOU actually do differently this summer?"*
- Students complete **Activity 5.4 — Diving, Shallow Water & Spinal Injury**. See teacher note below for delivery guidance and key statistics.

🦴 **Activity 5.4 — Diving, Shallow Water & Spinal Injury (new)**

This activity was added to address a significant gap in the original unit — diving and shallow-water spinal injury is the primary catastrophic risk for students in the 10–14 age group, yet it receives far less classroom attention than drowning. The three 2024–25 Australian case studies make this immediately relevant.

Key data to know before teaching:

- Unsafe diving = **10%** of all spinal cord injuries and **20%** of quadriplegia cases in Australia (AIHW)
- **95%** of aquatic spinal injury patients are male — **highest incidence age group: 10–14 years**
- Cervical vertebrae (C4–C6) fracture on head-first impact — spinal cord neurons cannot regenerate — **two-thirds** suffer permanent disability
- Three 2024–25 case studies: **Terrigal Wharf NSW** (shallow tidal water beneath wharf), **Torquay Front Beach VIC** (shifting sandbank at surf beach), **Bawley Beach NSW** (sandbank formed between visits — false confidence)

Teaching approach:

- Cold-open: display the six-stat data block (10%, 20%, 95%, 66%, 10–14, +34%) without context. Ask: *"What do you think these numbers describe?"* — consistently produces strong engagement because students are surprised it is not about drowning.
- Read the three case studies as a class. For each, ask: *"What specifically changed between the last safe visit and this injury?"* — lead students to the mechanism (sandbank, tidal variation, wharf depth) rather than just "they made a bad decision."

- Q5.4a asks students to reflect on their own risk — particularly for male students aged 10–14. Frame this as self-awareness, not accusation: *"The data describes a pattern — your job is to understand whether it applies to you and why."*
- **Sensitivity note:** some students may have personal connections to these injuries. Brief the class that the content involves real injuries before showing the statistics.
- Sources to cite: AIHW (aihw.gov.au), Royal Perth Hospital spinal injury review, RLSSA (royallifesaving.com.au)

📝 MONITOR PROGRESS — 5 MIN

Gallery Walk — SwimSafe Commitment

- Students share the SwimSafe rule they identified as most important for them (Workbook 6.1b) with a partner and explain their reasoning.
- Optional: post sticky notes on a class board under each of the 5 SwimSafe rules — which rule does the class think is most critical?

Review the success criteria. Students tick the success criteria in their workbook and write one sentence on the criterion they found hardest. Collect these — they tell you what to put in the Lesson 5 retrieval starter.

📌 PADDLE AUSTRALIA — CLASSROOM APPLICATION

Paddle Australia's safety resources are free and web-accessible. For students in regional Victoria, connecting water safety to specific local rivers (Yarra, Goulburn, Ovens, Mitchell) makes this content highly relevant. For Workbook Activity 5.1c, students visiting paddle.org.au will find river grading systems, water hazard descriptions, and safety checklists — excellent for the research task.

L5

Assessment + Community Action — Communication Campaign

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Section 6 | 🎯 VC2HP8P09, VC2HP8P10 | 🏫 Classroom

🔁 REVIEW — RETRIEVAL PRACTICE — 3 MIN

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Retrieval starter — the whole unit

- Mixed recall across all four lessons, no notes, 3 min. **1.** DRS ABCD in full. **2.** Two SwimSafe rules. **3.** What is cold water shock? **4.** One Victorian drowning statistic, with its year.

Why this is here. Retrieving prior learning from memory, rather than re-reading it, is what moves it into long-term memory. Keep it low-stakes and ungraded — the point is the act of recall, not the score. VTLM 2.0: *Retention and recall*.

🎯 FOCUS THE LEARNING — 8 MIN

LEARNING OBJECTIVE

Communicate accurate water safety information to a specific Victorian audience, and justify the choices I made.

SUCCESS CRITERIA — SHARE THESE WITH STUDENTS

- ☐ I can select water safety messages that match the audience I have chosen.
- ☐ I can use at least two accurate Victorian statistics, each with its source and year.
- ☐ I can justify my design and message choices against the assessment criteria.

Scenario Card Showdown + Assessment Briefing

- Quick Kahoot or Quizlet revision quiz (5 min) covering beach flags, DRS ABCD, SwimSafe rules, rip current escape, and Victorian statistics.
- Optional 3-min rapid fire: project one scenario card (e.g. **Card R1** or **P1**) — whole class calls out the correct action. Teacher confirms using the answer reveal. High engagement, low prep.

✏️ INDEPENDENT APPLICATION — YOU DO — 30 MIN

Assessment Task: Water Safety Communication Campaign (Workbook Activity 6.2)

Students choose ONE of three options from the workbook (all options are now built into the workbook):

- **Option A — Social media post** for teenagers (Instagram/TikTok style, 1–2 slides). Must include a statistic with source URL and a call to action. Mirrors **Extension Scenario Card X2**.
- **Option B — Letter to a Year 5 student** (approx. 200 words) explaining three things they must know about water safety in Victoria before summer.

- **Option C (Extension) — Multilingual community fact sheet** about beach flags and Victorian waterway dangers for someone new to Australia. Strongly recommended for CALD students — encourage use of home language. This directly addresses the finding that people from multicultural backgrounds account for 37% of Victorian drowning deaths since 2015–16.

Teacher tip: Encourage students to cite LSV, Parks Victoria, or Paddle Australia as sources — this reinforces the research literacy skill from VC2HP8P09.

📝 MONITOR PROGRESS 12 MIN

Workbook Collection + Self-Assessment + Peer Share

- Students complete the self-assessment checklist (now 8 criteria) on the back of their workbook.
- Optional: students share their campaign product with a partner — 2 min each. Partner gives one piece of feedback: *"One thing that would make this more persuasive is…"*
- Collect completed workbooks for teacher marking using the Assessment Gradebook rubric.

Review the success criteria. Students rate themselves against the three success criteria before handing in, then name the criterion their campaign evidences most strongly. This is the self-regulation step: they judge their own work against stated criteria before you do.

📌 CROSS-CURRICULAR OPPORTUNITIES

- **English/Literacy:** Option B (letter) directly develops persuasive writing and audience awareness skills
- **Mathematics:** Encourage all options to calculate or convert statistics (e.g. "1 in 5 = 20%" or "non-fatal drownings were 60% above average")
- **Languages:** Option C multilingual task is ideal for Languages classes to co-develop
- **Geography:** The action plan (6.1c) kayaking option links to Paddle Australia and Victorian river geography

🔑 5. Student Workbook — Answer Key

🔑 Section 1: Victorian Drowning Statistics

`ACTIVITY 1.2 — Data Table (What does this tell us?)` `interpretive — accept variety`

52 deaths: *Victoria recorded 52 fatal drownings in 2024–25, below the 2020–21 peak of 64 and the 59 recorded in 2022–23, but 9% above the ten-year average of 48. A fall from a recent peak is not the same as the problem being solved.*
About 1 in 8 aged 15–24: *Young people are significantly overrepresented, meaning age alone isn't protective — young people drown too.*
38 of 52 male (73%): *Males take more physical risks near water, often influenced by peer pressure or overconfidence in their abilities.*
All at unpatrolled sites: *If everyone swam only at patrolled locations, the death toll could theoretically be near zero.*

`Q 1.2a — TWO reasons teenagers are at higher risk (2 marks)  1 mark per valid reason`

Accept any two of: risk-taking behaviour common in adolescence; peer pressure to swim in unsafe places; overconfidence in swimming ability; tendency to swim at unpatrolled locations; lack of awareness of hidden dangers like rip currents or cold water; social norms around not 'backing down' from dares.

`Q 1.2b — What unpatrolled location data suggests (2 marks)`

Model answer: Victoria recorded zero public-pool drowning deaths in 2024–25, which suggests trained lifeguards and supervision are extremely effective where they are present. The limit of that argument is that a quarter of deaths occurred in home environments, which no lifeguard can reach. Swimming at patrolled beaches/pools dramatically reduces risk because someone is watching and able to respond in seconds. This makes swimming at patrolled locations one of the single most important things people can do to stay safe.

🔑 Section 2: Beach Flags & Rip Currents

`Activity 2.1 — Flag Identification`

Flag 1: Red & Yellow — Patrolled swimming area; always swim here
Flag 2: Red — Dangerous conditions; experienced swimmers only or do not enter
Flag 3: Black & White Quartered — Surfboards/watercraft zone; swimmers stay out
Flag 4: Yellow + Black Ball — No surfboards; swimming only in this zone
Flag 5: Orange Windsock — Offshore winds; no inflatables allowed
Flag 6: Purple — Dangerous marine life spotted; swim with caution

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`Q 2.2a — THREE steps if caught in a rip (3 marks, 1 per valid step)`

1. Stay calm and don't panic — conserve energy.
2. Float or tread water rather than fighting the current.

3. Swim parallel to the shore (not directly in) to escape the current's channel, then angle back to shore. If unable to reach shore, raise one arm and call/signal for help.

`Q 2.2b — Why swimming directly against a rip is dangerous (2 marks)`

A rip current can move at speeds up to 2.5 m/s — faster than most swimmers can sprint. Swimming directly against it uses enormous energy very quickly, leading to exhaustion and then drowning. The swimmer makes no progress against the current, becomes panicked, and loses the ability to stay afloat.

`Q 2.2c — Liam's scenario: TWO mistakes and what should have been done (4 marks)`

Mistake 1: Swimming at an unpatrolled beach. They should have gone to a patrolled beach where lifeguards could respond within seconds.
Mistake 2: Liam tried to swim directly against the rip current, exhausting himself. He should have stayed calm, floated, swum parallel to shore, and if needed, raised his arm to signal for help.
Bonus: His friends didn't know what to do — they should have known to call 000 immediately and throw something that floats rather than entering the water themselves.

🔑 Section 3: DRS ABCD

`Activity 3.1 — DRS ABCD words`

D — DANGER | R — RESPONSE | S — SEND (for help / call 000) | A — AIRWAY | B — BREATHING | C — CPR | D — DEFIBRILLATION

`Q 3.2a — First action at River Rope Swing (2 marks)`

First action: Do NOT jump in. Call 000 (or shout for someone else to call while you act). Then use the rope from the swing to throw to the person (throw rescue). This is safer than entering water and risking becoming another casualty. The rope from the swing is already available.

`Q 3.2b — Why the friend jumping in was dangerous (2 marks)`

The untrained friend who jumped in creates a second casualty risk. When a person is drowning, they involuntarily grab anything within reach (including the rescuer) and may push the rescuer underwater in their panic. Without rescue training, entering the water dramatically increases the chance of two drownings, not one.

🔑 Section 4: SwimSafe Rules, Hazard Mapping & Decision-Making

`Activity 4.0 — Hazard Mapping Table` `accept well-reasoned responses`

> ***Beach (patrolled):*** *Rip currents (H), sunburn/heat illness (M), jellyfish (M), rough surf/waves (H), swimming outside flags (H). Safe: swim between flags, check conditions, sun protection.*
> ***River/Dam:*** *Cold water shock (H), submerged objects/debris (H), strong currents especially after rain (H), no lifeguard (H), unknown depth (H). Safe: enter feet first, never swim alone, check weather/conditions, wear lifejacket for boating.*
> ***Pool:*** *Unsupervised young children (H), diving into shallow end (H), drains (M), glass near pool (L), no adult supervision (H). Safe: always watch children, no diving in shallow water, pool fencing.*

`Q 4.0a — Most dangerous environment + evidence (2 marks)`

> *Model answer: Rivers and dams are the most dangerous overall. The LSV 2024–25 data shows 29% of deaths occurred in inland waterways (11 at rivers, creeks and streams) and 38% in coastal waterways, while public swimming pools recorded none. Unlike patrolled beaches, rivers have no lifeguard supervision, cold water shock risk, hidden currents, submerged hazards, and conditions that change rapidly (especially after rain). Accept any well-argued response supported by data.*

`Activity 4 — LSV SwimSafe 5 Rules (from memory)`

> *1. Read signs · 2. Enter feet first · 3. Stay in depth · 4. Swim with a friend · 5. Signal for help*
> *Source: Life Saving Victoria — https://lsv.com.au*

🔑 Section 5: Inland Waterways, Throw Rescue & Alcohol

`Activity 5.2 — Throw Rescue Ranking (RLSSA hierarchy)` `accept logical reasoning`

> *Best to worst:* ***1. Life ring attached to jetty*** *— attached, won't sink, can be pulled back;* ***2. Coiled rope/throw bag*** *— can throw to distance and pull person in;* ***3. Extending towel/clothing from bank*** *— limited reach, only effective if person is close;* ***4. Throwing pool noodle/esky lid*** *— buoyant but no line to pull person in;* ***5. Jumping in*** *— most dangerous option, should only be done by trained rescuers with a flotation device. Award marks for reasoning, not just ranking order.*
> *Source: RLSSA Talk → Reach → Throw → Row → Go hierarchy — https://www.royallifesaving.com.au*

`Q 5.3a — THREE ways alcohol increases drowning risk (3 marks, 1 per valid effect)`

> *Accept any three of: impaired judgement (overestimates swimming ability, takes more risks); reduced coordination (can't swim effectively); slowed reaction time (slower to respond to danger); impaired body temperature regulation (increases hypothermia risk in cold water); reduced ability to hold breath; false confidence leading to swimming in unsafe locations or depths.*

`Q 5.3b — TWO specific risks in pool party alcohol scenario (2 marks)`

> *Accept any two of: night-time swimming means poor visibility — harder to see if person goes under; alcohol impairs the ability to assess depth or distance; CPR/rescue response is complicated by the alcohol use of bystanders; a person who goes unconscious in the water at night may not be noticed; alcohol-affected friends are less likely to identify an emergency quickly and respond correctly. Accept well-reasoned alternatives.*

📊 6. Assessment Strategies & Rubric

📐 Assessment Overview — Formative & Summative

Task	Type	Timing	Worth
Exit tickets (Lessons 1, 2, 3)	Formative	End of each lesson	Ungraded — teacher feedback
Student workbook (Sections 1–6, including new Activities 4.0, 5.2, 5.3)	Summative	Collected end of unit	40% of unit grade (teacher's discretion)
CPR / rescue role-play observation	Formative practical	Lesson 3	Teacher observation checklist
Communication campaign task (Workbook Activity 6.2 — Options A, B, or C)	Summative	Lesson 5 / homework	60% of unit grade (teacher's discretion)

See the separate **Assessment Gradebook** file for the full A–E rubric with 7 criteria, editable class tracker, and report comment generator.

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📋 Workbook Marking Rubric

A full 7-criteria A–E rubric with report comment generator is in the separate **Assessment Gradebook** file. This abbreviated rubric (E/C/A) is suitable for quick marking and oral feedback.

Criteria	E (Emerging)	C (Consolidating)	A (Achieving)
Knowledge of water safety facts and statistics	Limited or inaccurate facts; relies on general statements	Accurate facts from class/workbook; some elaboration	Accurate, well-chosen facts with elaboration; references to LSV data; demonstrates genuine understanding
Hazard mapping & risk assessment (Activity 4.0)	Names only obvious hazards; no ranking or explanation	Identifies key hazards across most environments; some explanation of risk level	Systematically identifies and ranks hazards; explains specific mechanisms of danger; supports reasoning with Victorian context or data
LSV SwimSafe rules application (Workbook Section 4, Activity 6.1b)	Cannot recall most rules; cannot apply them to real situations	Recalls most SwimSafe rules accurately; applies them in at least one scenario	Recalls all 5 rules accurately; applies them across different waterway types; identifies which is most personally relevant and explains why with specificity
Application to scenarios	Responses are superficial; doesn't apply DRS ABCD or flag knowledge correctly	Applies most correct steps; some logical gaps in scenarios	Consistently applies correct procedures; clearly justifies decisions with reasoning; shows critical thinking
Throw rescue & emergency response (Activity 5.2, Section 3)	Unable to rank rescue options; does not understand why entering water is dangerous	Ranks rescue options mostly correctly; understands throw rescue principle; some gaps in DRS ABCD	Accurately ranks and justifies rescue hierarchy using RLSSA framework; applies DRS ABCD correctly; explains secondary drowning risk of untrained rescuers

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Criteria	E (Emerging)	C (Consolidating)	A (Achieving)
Personal action plan	Generic or incomplete; 'I will be careful' type answers	Specific to own life; at least two realistic commitments; chosen scenario plan has most key elements	Highly specific, realistic, and personalised; shows genuine reflection on own habits and risks; action plan for chosen scenario is thorough and detailed
Communication campaign task	Incomplete; vague message; no clear audience; basic language	Clear message; appropriate for audience; includes one relevant fact with source; mostly correct	Compelling, audience-appropriate content; uses accurate data with source URL cited; clear call to action; demonstrates communication skills aligned to chosen format

♿ 7. Differentiation & Inclusion

Where this sits in your planning — reasonable adjustments and IEPs

Everything in this section is provision you can record as a **reasonable adjustment**. It is written here as teaching advice, but it maps directly onto the language of an Individual Education Plan or student profile, so it can be lifted into planning you are already doing rather than sitting alongside it as a separate thing.

Adjustment type	What this unit already supplies	Record it as
Presentation of content	Simplified and scaffolded workbook versions; visual guides and posters; the glossary; multilingual parent information.	Modified text complexity; visual and first-language support.
Student response	Sentence starters and word banks; oral alternatives to written responses; three assessment task options; choice of campaign format.	Alternative response mode; scaffolded written output.

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Adjustment type	What this unit already supplies	Record it as
Participation	The non-swimmer pathway and the dry-land delivery of the whole unit; buddy pairing in practical sessions; the option to step out of content that touches personal loss.	Adjusted participation with equivalent learning outcomes.
Time and pacing	Stated phase timings you can extend; activities that can be split across lessons; Activity 6.3 able to run as homework.	Extended time; reduced task volume at the same standard.
Extension	Extension workbook versions; primary-source tasks; the evidence-hierarchy and transfer questions in the interleaved retrieval set.	Extension against the same content descriptions.

Two things worth saying plainly. First, an adjustment is about access, not about lowering the standard — a student using a scaffolded workbook is working towards the same content descriptions as everyone else, and should be assessed against them. Second, adjust per task and per student, not per label: the same student may need the scaffolded version for the data activities and the standard version for the rescue content, in the same lesson.

For a student working towards the Foundation achievement standard, the Victorian Curriculum **Levels A–D** are the planning reference rather than the Levels 7–10 content descriptions — the water safety content still applies, sequenced differently.

Pair high expectations with the support that makes them reachable. The department's framing is worth saying out loud to students: *"I know you can do this"* together with *"I'll help you learn how."* Water safety is an area where low expectations do measurable harm — a student written off as a non-swimmer is a student who leaves school without the content most likely to save their life.

VTLM 2.0: Inclusive learning, Practice 1 — maintain high expectations, enable full participation. Departmental supports: the Diverse Learners Hub, Disability Inclusion funding, and your school's wellbeing team for IEP processes.

🌐 CALD (Culturally and Linguistically Diverse) Students

Priority note: Life Saving Victoria reports that people from multicultural backgrounds accounted for 185 Victorian drowning deaths since 2015–16 — 37% of the total, with country of birth unknown in a further 22% of cases. This unit is particularly important for students, and the communication campaign task is the highest-impact activity for community reach.

- LSV provides translated water safety resources in Arabic, Vietnamese, Chinese, Somali, and other languages: https://lsv.com.au/community/multicultural-safety/

- The Victorian Government's water safety page also has multilingual resources: https://www.vic.gov.au/water-safety
- Allow students to share culturally different relationships with water — not all cultures traditionally swim; validate diverse experiences while communicating the importance of learning water safety regardless of background.
- Pair CALD students with supportive peers for scenario activities; allow translation of key terms using home language or digital tools where helpful.
- **Communication Campaign Option C** (multilingual fact sheet) is specifically designed for CALD students — encourage them to create it in their home language. This is a highly meaningful task that extends reach into the community beyond the classroom.
- When discussing fishing-related drowning (more than half of fishing deaths in the past decade involve people from CALD backgrounds), handle with cultural sensitivity — frame as information, not judgment.
- If running Lesson 1 with a high-CALD cohort, be aware that some students may have direct family experience with water safety challenges related to cultural background and limited swimming opportunity.

📈 Extension Students (High Achieving)

- Assign **Extension Scenario Cards X1, X2, and X3** from the Scenario Activity Card pack. X1 is a full data analysis task comparing Victorian and national drowning data; X2 is the communication campaign; X3 investigates the physiology of drowning (cerebral hypoxia, CPR mechanics).
- Research task: Investigate how the LSV drowning report data compares to national data from Royal Life Saving Australia (https://www.royallifesaving.com.au/research). What are the key differences between Victorian and other state/territory rates?
- Design a school swim safety awareness week proposal, including activities, Poster 4 (SwimSafe) display, guest speakers from LSV, and RLSSA resources.
- Investigate the physiology of cold water shock using the 1-10-1 rule — write a summary for the school LMS or health notice board.
- Compare dry-land water safety education approaches between Australia (LSV/RLSSA), UK (RLSS UK), and USA (Red Cross). What are the key differences? Which approach do you think is most effective for teenagers? Cite sources from all three organisations.
- **Gamification extension:** Run **all 12 scenario cards** as a timed group challenge — groups compete to correctly answer the most scenarios. Teacher uses the on-screen answer reveals. Works well as an end-of-unit review or for a double lesson.

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♿ Students with Additional Needs

- Workbook activities can be completed verbally with a scribe or using speech-to-text tools.
- CPR practical component: students with physical limitations can observe and provide verbal guidance to a partner — full marks available for verbal accuracy without physical demonstration.
- Simplified answer scaffolds can be provided for written questions (sentence starters, word banks, visual cue cards).
- For the Communication Campaign (Activity 6.2), the oral option — explaining to the teacher or presenting to a small group — is a valid and fully assessable alternative to written options.
- The SwimSafe 5 rules (Poster 4) make a strong visual memory support — laminate a personal copy for students who benefit from visual cues.
- Scenario Cards can be adapted — provide fewer questions per card, or pre-select the 5 most accessible cards for targeted use.

🏊 Non-Swimmers and Students Who Avoid Water

- This unit is deliberately fully classroom-based and dry-land. No student should feel embarrassed about swimming ability levels at any point.
- Activity 1.1 (swimming ability self-rating) is for the student's personal reflection only — do not ask students to share this publicly.
- Frame the unit message consistently: *"Being water smart isn't about being a great swimmer — it's about making safe decisions before and after you get near water. The data shows that knowing what to do saves lives."*
- The SwimSafe rules and DRS ABCD are equally important for non-swimmers — in fact, recognising dangerous situations *before* entering water is arguably the most important skill for a non-swimmer to develop.
- For students who have had negative water experiences, the Communication Campaign Option B (letter to younger student) allows them to process and share knowledge without requiring personal disclosure.

🎓 8. Teacher Background Knowledge

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🌊 Key Water Safety Facts for Teachers

- **The 1-10-1 rule (cold water):** You have approximately 1 minute to control your breathing when you enter cold water, 10 minutes of useful swimming ability before your muscles lose coordination, and up to 1 hour of survival time before hypothermia sets in (in most adult adults).
- **Rip currents:** Account for approximately 80% of lifeguard rescues at Australian beaches. They are NOT undertows (which don't exist) — they move laterally, not down. They are actually calmer-looking water between breaking waves.
- **CPR rates:** Bystander CPR doubles or triples survival rates for cardiac arrest. Every second counts — CPR should start within 4 minutes of a cardiac arrest to give the best chance of brain function being preserved.
- **Throw, don't go:** Most non-professional bystander drownings occur when a friend or family member attempts an in-water rescue without training. A throw rescue with any floating object from the bank is always safer.
- **AEDs:** Automated External Defibrillators are in many public spaces in Victoria (pools, shopping centres, schools). They are designed to be used by untrained bystanders — the device will not shock a heart that doesn't need it. Know where your school's AED is located before teaching this unit.

📌 KNOW YOUR SCHOOL'S EMERGENCY PLAN

Before teaching this unit, ensure you know: (1) where your school's AED is located, (2) your school's emergency response protocol for water-related incidents at excursions, (3) the wellbeing referral pathway if a student shares personal trauma related to drowning. Review the DE Swimming and Water Safety policy annually.

9. Resources & Sources

🎓 Victorian Curriculum (VCAA)

HPE Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0, content descriptions and achievement standards

https://f10.vcaa.vic.edu.au/health-and-physical-education/curriculum/f-10

🏊 Life Saving Victoria (LSV)

Primary Victorian resource. Drowning reports, classroom lessons, SwimSafe program, multicultural resources, LSV Toolkit — all free and VCAA-aligned

https://lsv.com.au

https://lsv.com.au/toolkit

https://lsv.com.au/community/multicultural-safety/

📊 LSV Annual Drowning Reports

Updated annually. 2024–25 report: 52 deaths, 9% above the ten-year average; zero in public swimming pools. Essential for Workbook Section 1 data activities.

https://lsv.com.au/what-we-do/research-advocacy

🏅 Royal Life Saving Society Australia (RLSSA)

Swim & Survive program, Bronze e-Lifesaving, classroom dry-land modules, throw rescue hierarchy guidelines. Used for Workbook Activity 5.2.

https://www.royallifesaving.com.au

https://www.drowningprevention.org.au/swimandsurvive

🛶 Paddle Australia

Inland waterway safety for rivers, lakes, and moving water — critical Victorian context. Used for Workbook Activity 5.1c research task and kayaking action plan option.

https://paddle.org.au

🌿 Parks Victoria

Victorian natural environment waterway hazards — localised content for Yarra River, Alpine regions, national parks. Excellent for scenario-based classroom activities.

https://www.parks.vic.gov.au

🎓 AUSTSWIM

National swimming teacher training. Frameworks for lesson design, skill progression, inclusion strategies. Useful for planning CPR and rescue skill components.

https://austswim.com.au

🏖 BeachSafe App (SLSA)

Free app showing patrolled beaches, patrol hours, conditions. Student task: find nearest 3 patrolled beaches. Used in Lessons 2 and 4.

https://beachsafe.org.au

🏄 Surf Life Saving Australia

Rip current videos, beach safety education, volunteer information. Video recommended for Lesson 2 rip current explanation.

https://sls.com.au/surf-safety/rip-currents/

🩺 St John Ambulance Victoria

CPR & DRS ABCD resources, first aid fact sheets, free printable guides. Central to Lesson 3 content.

https://www.stjohnvic.com.au/first-aid-resources/

🏛 Victorian Government Water Safety

Multilingual resources, beach water quality forecasts, inland waterway guidance, Play it Safe by the Water program.

https://www.vic.gov.au/water-safety

https://www.police.vic.gov.au/beach-and-waterways-safety

🏫 DE Swimming & Water Safety Policy

Mandatory policy for all Victorian government schools. Covers curriculum requirements, funding, excursion guidelines, and the School Swimming Toolkit.

https://www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/swimming-instruction-and-water-safety-education/policy

📖 VCAA HPE Teaching Resources

Sample F–10 swimming and water safety activities aligned to Curriculum 2.0, achievement standards, and assessment strategies.

https://www.vcaa.vic.edu.au/curriculum/foundation-10/curriculum-area-resources/health-and-physical-education/teaching-resources

🌊 LSV + VCAA Progressions Guide

Swimming and Water Safety F–10 Progression Model — competency expectations at every curriculum level, co-developed by LSV and VCAA.

https://lsv.com.au/toolkit

🇬🇧 RLSS UK — Education Resources

International classroom lesson plans, water safety scenarios, rescue decision-making frameworks. Free downloads. Good for extension comparison tasks.

https://www.rlss.org.uk/education

🇺🇸 American Red Cross — Water Safety

"Think So You Don't Sink" decision-making model. Engaging videos for teens. Good for cross-referencing with Australian data in Extension Card X1.

https://www.redcross.org/take-a-class/water-safety

🇺🇸 CDC Drowning Prevention

US public health drowning data and prevention research. Strong for numeracy-linked cross-curricular comparison tasks (Extension Card X1).

https://www.cdc.gov/drowning/prevention

📰 LSV Blog — Curriculum 2.0

LSV explanation of changes under Victorian Curriculum 2.0 and what they mean for school HPE programs.

https://blog.lsv.com.au/2025/07/09/swimming-and-water-safety-in-the-new-victorian-curriculum-f-10-2-0/

📚 Suggested Videos for Classroom Use

- **LSV 'Watch and Learn' Water Safety Series** (classroom-ready, curriculum-linked): https://lsv.com.au/toolkit
- **SLSA Rip Current Education** (recommended Lesson 2 video, ~4 min): https://sls.com.au/surf-safety/rip-currents/
- **Victoria Police Beach & Waterways Safety**: https://www.police.vic.gov.au/beach-and-waterways-safety
- **RLSSA Cold Water Safety** (recommended Lesson 4): Search "Royal Life Saving cold water shock" on YouTube or visit https://www.royallifesaving.com.au
- **Red Cross water safety videos** (engaging for teens, good for Lesson 4): https://www.redcross.org/take-a-class/water-safety

📦 Your Complete Package — File Summary

File	Purpose	Primary Use
swim_safety_poster_pack	4 A3 classroom posters (DRS ABCD, Beach Flags, Drowning Stats, SwimSafe Rules)	Display during unit; visual reference throughout all lessons
swim_safety_student_workbook	6-section student workbook with ~35 activities	Distributed to students; used across all 5 lessons; collected as summative evidence
swim_safety_teacher_workbook	This document — lesson plans, answer key, rubric, differentiation, resources	Teacher planning and delivery reference; not for student distribution

File	Purpose	Primary Use
water_safety_resource_directory	11 organisations with descriptions, dry-land applicability notes, and verified URLs	Teacher reference; share with HPE faculty; use for planning additional units
water_safety_scenario_cards	12 printable scenario cards (Beach, River, Pool, Emergency, Decision-Making) + 3 extension cards	Print and laminate; use as station activities, pair tasks, or quick-fire review games
water_safety_assessment_gradebook	4-tab interactive tool: full A–E rubric, curriculum alignment, class tracker, report comment generator	Assessment and reporting; generate Victorian Curriculum-aligned report comments

Swim & Water Safety — Teacher Resource Guide
Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 · HPE · Year 7–8 · Safety Focus Area
Content descriptions: VC2HP8P08 · VC2HP8P09 · VC2HP8P10 · VC2HP8M01

For teacher use only · Not for student distribution
Sources verified April 2026
Visit https://lsv.com.au/toolkit/ for latest LSV classroom resources

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Data sources cited in this resource. Drowning statistics are reproduced with attribution from: Life Saving Victoria. (2025). *Victorian Drowning Report 2024–25*. Life Saving Victoria: Melbourne. Royal Life Saving Australia (2026). *National Drowning Report 2026*. RLSSA: Sydney. World Health Organization (2024). *Drowning — fact sheet*. WHO: Geneva. Surf Life Saving Australia (2026). *Summer Coastal Drowning Report 2025/26*. SLSA: Sydney. These figures remain the property of the publishing organisations. If you adapt this resource, retain these citations.